

MALIC/MBA: Literature review and search techniques

Library & Learning Services
York St John University

Outline of session

- Introduction to literature review
- Search strategy and techniques
- Overview of databases and search example
- Search exercise



Explore the literature in order to identify

What is already known about the topic

What concepts and theories are relevant

What research methods and strategies have been used to study the topic

Whether there are any significant controversies

Whether there are any inconsistencies in findings of published research

Whether there are any unanswered research questions

(Based on Bryman, 2016)

Literature review process

Saunders, Lewis & Thornhill 2019, p.75.

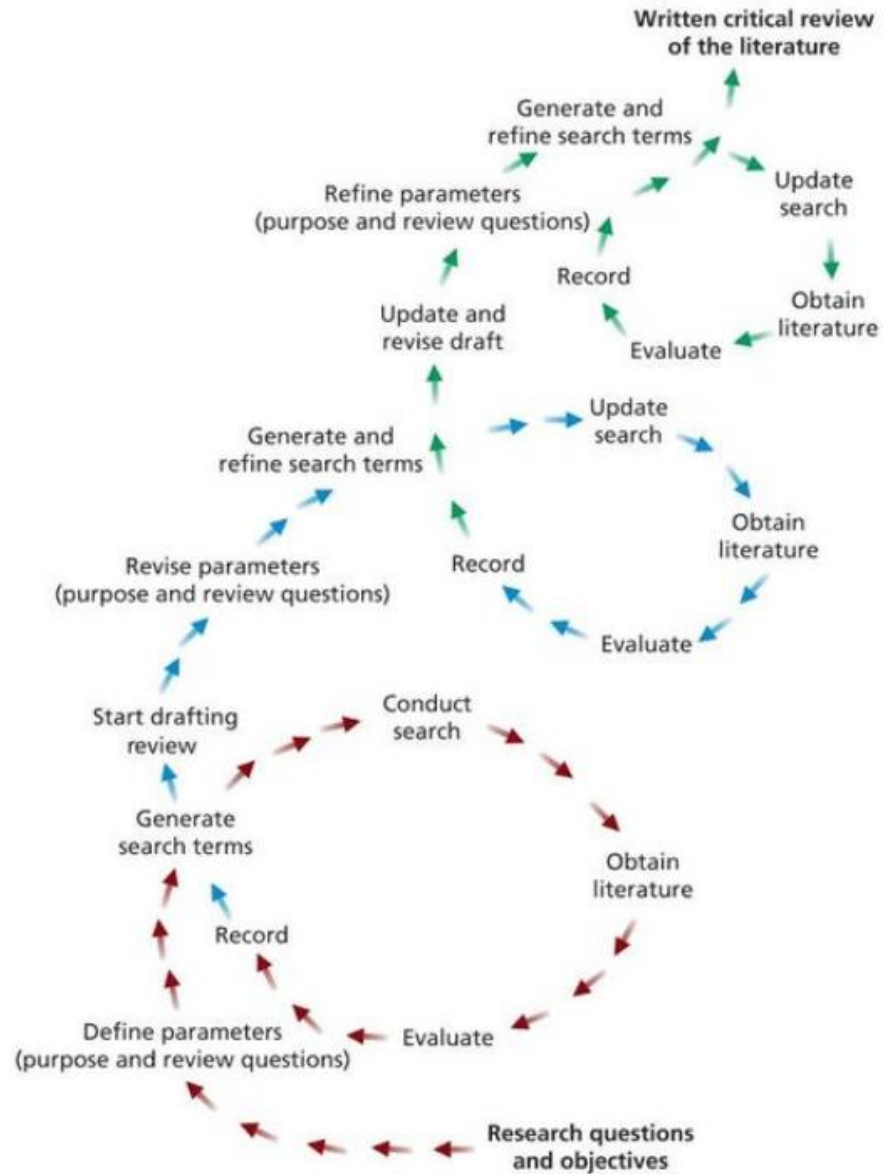


Figure 3.1 The literature review process

A good review

Focuses on relevant and recent ideas

Critically reviews the ideas

Bell & Waters (2014, p.97) state:

A literature review should be more than just a list of references that are relevant to your research topic. A critical review involves questioning assumptions, querying claims made for which no evidence has been provided, considering the findings of one researcher versus those of others and evaluating the conclusions drawn.

A weak review

Uses only mainstream, general writers, and/or old publications

Describes ideas, rather than critically analysing them

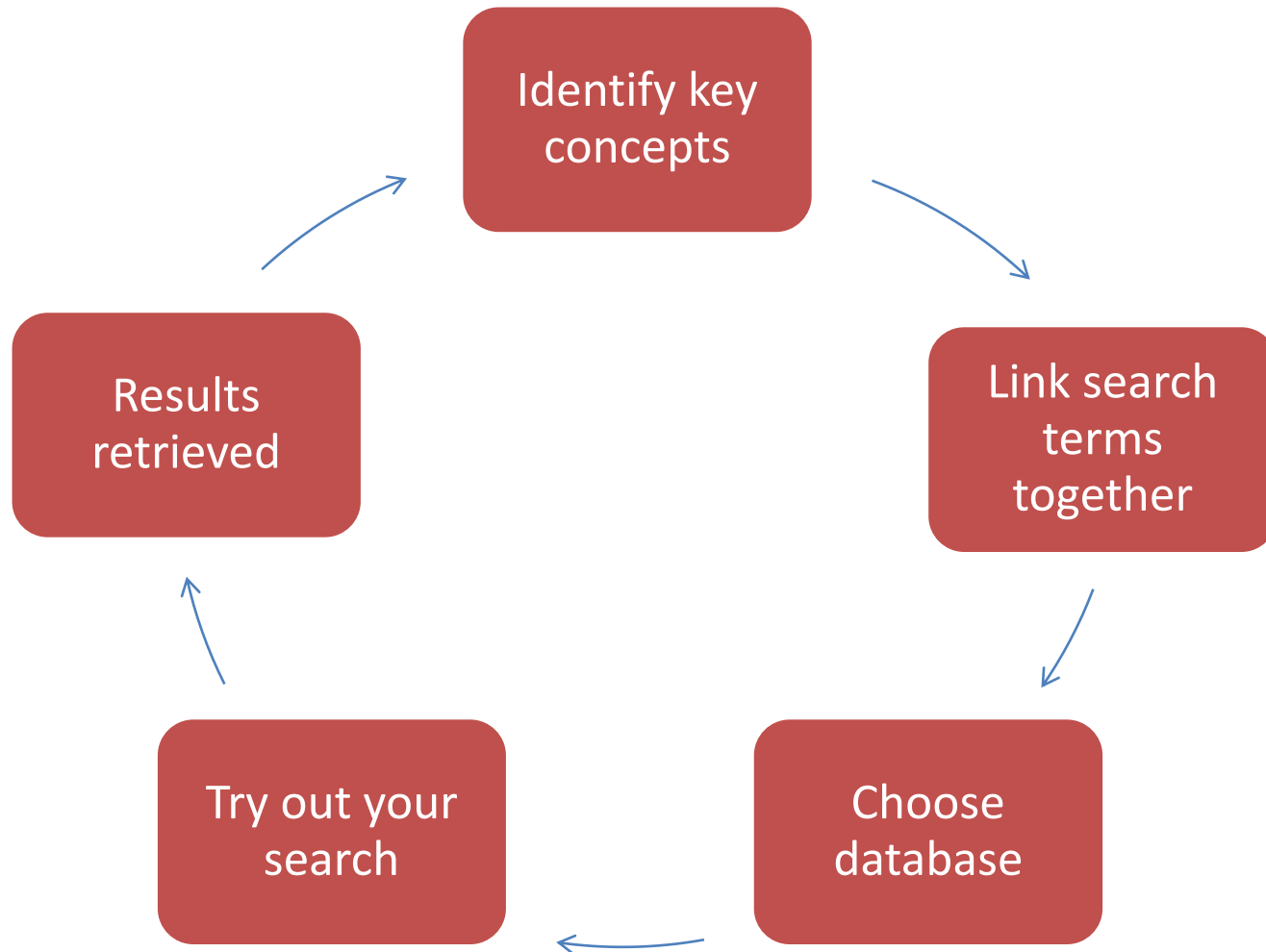
Omits easily obtainable, relevant material

Assessor comment: “Google Scholar contains 41,800 sources relating to XXX culture studies and 12,400 studies related to XXX leadership of which 6,370 are specifically related to the XXX military leadership. This calls into question the statements regarding 'no literature available in these topic areas.'”

A critical review

- The capacity to evaluate what you read
- Capacity to relate what you read to other information
 - (Wallace & Wray 2016, p.8)
- Critical questions to consider
 - Why am I reading this? The relevance of the article to your research focus
 - What is the author trying to do in writing the article?
 - Is what the author is saying justified by the evidence presented?
 - What use can I make of the article?
- To find out more about literature reviews, there are useful chapters that you can read from ebooks available at York St John (see final slide)

Search for literature



Identify key concepts

- Clarify and define your research question
 - Identify key concepts (the main elements in your topic)
 - Think of Keywords to describe each concept
- Expressing your search terms

Search tips	Example	Effect
Word variants using * (asterisk) Known as truncation	leader*	finds the following variants of the word: leader, leaders, leadership
Quotation marks (“...”) (phrase search)	“small business”	Finds those exact words in that order
Alternative spellings use # or ?	organi#ation	Finds either spelling of the word with s or z

Link search terms together

- ▶ [Youtube video](#) – Using AND, OR, NOT to connect your terms
 - ▶ watch part of the video from 53 secs- 2 min

Search tips – linking words	Example	Effect
Use AND to link different key concepts of your topic	gender AND leadership	Finds records containing both terms (narrows search)
Use OR to link terms with similar meanings (synonyms)	job OR occupation	Finds records containing either or any of the terms (widens search)

Database	Coverage
Access to all these is via our specialist resources page at: http://libguides.yorks.ac.uk/az.php?s=109348	
Library catalogue	Search for ebooks and simple search for full text journal articles
Discover	All our full text journal articles (Ebsco)
Emerald	Full text journal articles in business and management
Business source premier	Business articles & reports – some full text & some abstracts only (Ebsco)
Global Newsstream	Full text British daily newspapers plus other newspapers/ magazines
PsycINFO/PsycArticles	Abstracts of articles and books on topics concerning work psychology & motivation (Ebsco)
SCOPUS	Peer-reviewed journal articles and conference papers
Euromonitor	Market research database providing data analysis on industries, economies, countries and consumers.
HS Talks	Videos and case studies on business topics
FAME	Company financial information (UK only)
Marketline	Company, industry and country information (international)
Global Market Navigator	International comparative statistics about products /industries
Mintel	Market information for the UK in 5 streams: E-commerce, travel, Leisure, Food, Clothing and footwear. Mintel Trends.

Search example:

- The manager's role in engaging employees in the process of change
- The /**manager's**/ role in /**engaging employees**/in the process of /**change**/

	Key concept 1	Key concept 2	Key concept 3	Limits
		AND	AND	AND
	"organizational change"	manager	"employee engagement"	Date range: 2008-2018
OR	"change management"	leader	"employee motivation"	Type of publication: academic journals
OR			"employee attitudes"	Index to search: Abstract?

Searching: Discover

AB Abstract ▾

Search

AND ▾

AB Abstract ▾

Clear ?

AND ▾

Select a Field (optional) ▾

+ -

[Basic Search](#) [Advanced Search](#) [Search History](#)

**Saves your result
in a folder (sign
in first)**

 Detailed Record Full Text Finder

**Link to full
article**

[◀ Result List](#) [Refine Search](#) [◀ 17 of 287 ▶](#)

Factors that impact the success of an organizational change: a case study analysis.

Authors: Appelbaum, Steven H.
Cameron, Aleksey
Ensink, Floris
Hazarika, Jahnabi
Attir, Raid
Ezzedine, Rouba
Shekhar, Varsha

Source: Industrial & Commercial Training; 2017, Vol. 49 Issue 5, p213-230, 18p

Publication Year: 2017

Subject Terms: ORGANIZATIONAL change
INDEPENDENT variables
EMPLOYEES
TRANSFORMATIONAL leadership
BUSINESS cycles
SAMPLE size (Statistics)
EXECUTIVES

**Author-Supplied
Keywords:** Commitment to change
Communication
Culture
Leadership
Team integration

Abstract: Purpose The purpose of this paper is to investigate the factors that impact the success of an organizational change within an organization under study. Design/methodology/approach Five hypotheses were developed to investigate independent variables as possible factors affecting employees' commitment to change. The research is based on a three-step process consisting of a literature review and field research through survey and interviews. The literature review served to establish an important foundation for understanding the problem. The field research involved employees taking part in the change completing a survey. Individual interviews were also conducted with management level employees actively involved in the change process. The

**Export result to
Refworks**

Journal details

Tools

 Google Drive Add to folder Print E-mail Save Cite Export Create Note Permalink Share

Exercise

Use the Discover database and find up to six journal articles relevant to your area of research.

Note the search terms you used in order to find the material.

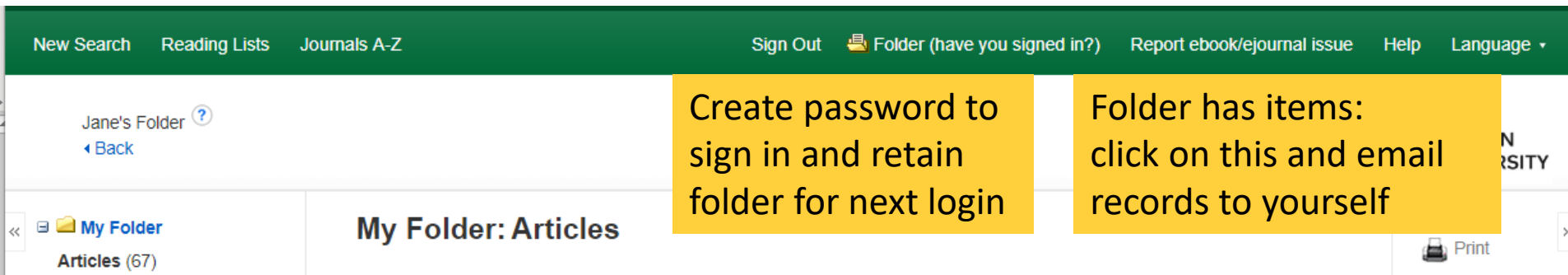
You might wish to use the search 'form' to record these. (Handed out in session or print off from slide 18 if wish to re-use).

Remember you can also save searches in Discover – see slide 15

Come back to the small groups and share your experiences.
Do you have any tips, based on what worked for you?
Do you have any questions or issues you'd like to raise?

Save results on Ebsco (includes Discover)

- Use the 'blue symbol'  next to each record to 'add to folder' relevant records. To retrieve and email them to yourself, go to the top of the screen and the 'folder has items' icon.
- Select all the items in the folder and click on email (right side of screen) to send the results to your mail box.
- **To keep for next time you login, you must Sign in and create an account.** Then you can just keep the articles in the folder to refer to later and you can download them all to Refworks to create your bibliography. You can also save your search using Search history link and save.
- Once you have created an account this will work on all Ebsco databases such as Discover, Business source premier and PsycINFO.



The screenshot shows the Ebsco interface with a green navigation bar at the top containing links for 'New Search', 'Reading Lists', 'Journals A-Z', 'Sign Out', 'Folder (have you signed in?)', 'Report ebook/ejournal issue', 'Help', and 'Language'. Below the navigation bar, there is a section for 'Jane's Folder' with a question mark icon and a 'Back' link. A yellow callout box is overlaid on the right side of the screen, containing the text: 'Create password to sign in and retain folder for next login' and 'Folder has items: click on this and email records to yourself'. At the bottom, there is a section for 'My Folder: Articles' with a sub-section for 'Articles (67)'.

Google Scholar

- Google scholar

Importance of workplace relationships and attitudes toward **organizational change** in engineering asset-management organizations

[MJ Xerri](#), [S Nelson](#), [Y Brunetto](#) - *Journal of Management in ...*, 2014 - ascelibrary.org

... 164 (64.3%) were asset **managers**, 45 (17.6%) were asset **management** engineers, and 46 were asset maintenance employees (18%; Fig. ... Table 1. Asset **Management** Respondents by State.

Table 1. Asset **Management** Respondents by State. ... Asset **manager**, 24, 57, 55, 10, 10, 2 ...

☆ ⓘ Cited by 10 Related articles All 5 versions Import into RefWorks

[PDF] scu.edu.au
Get it @ YSJ



Accessible via YSJ

Select link to add
reference to Refworks



- Use advanced search
- Includes links to articles which have cited your selected article so creates literature trail
- To display if available from York St John - choose settings, library links search for York St John University and save (note of caution: occasionally this means that we have it in print only)
- To display Import into Refworks link, choose settings, Bib Manager, Refworks

Refworks

The screenshot displays the Refworks web interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options: All Documents, Search Databases, Last Imported, Sharing, My Folders, Add a folder, Not in Folder, Banking in Africa, Change management (selected), coaching, Communication, entrepreneur2, Entrepreneurship, finance, Financial management, France, Global warming, Linguistics, Mullins books, organic food, Psychology, Psychology reading list, and punk rock. The main area shows a list of articles under the 'Change management' filter, sorted by date added. The selected article is 'How does leader communication style promote employees commitment at times of change?' by Luo, W., Song, L.J., Gebert, D.R., Zhang, K. and Feng, Y. (2016). The right-hand pane provides a detailed view of this article, including the Emerald Insight logo, article title, authors, a 'Read' button, a QR code, and a 'Change.pdf' download link. Below the article information are tags such as '2016', 'Affective commitment to change', 'Communication', 'Employee Attitudes', 'Leader communication style', 'Leadership Style', 'Organizational change', 'Organizational Commitment', 'Supervisor Employee Interaction', and 'Supervisor-subordinate communication'. At the bottom, there is an 'Attachments' section showing 'Change.pdf (248 KB)'.

Bibliographic referencing software

- Log on via our webpage
- Download references from databases
- Manage and store your references
- Create bibliography in Harvard style

Recording your search

	Key concept 1	Key concept 2	Key concept 3	Key concept 4	Limits
		AND	AND	AND	AND
					Limit to an search index eg: Abstract index
OR					Limit to recent publication dates?
OR					Type of literature (academic journal articles, peer reviewed)
OR					

Note: Search for phrases using inverted commas around the words eg: “organizational change”. Using the * symbol will find extensions of the word so leader* finds leader, leaders, leadership.

Recording/categorising the literature

	A	B	C	D	E
1	Article details	Purpose / aims	Theme	Research design/focus/methodology	Findings/conclusions/limitations
2	Luo et al. How does leader communication style promote employees' commitment..... Journal of organizational change management	To explore how the style of leader communication about change could influence employee attitudes	Communication	Original research. Questionnaire distributed to managers and team members to consider 5 dimensions of leader communication style which is analysed by creation of a scale to measure the dimensions and test the link between leader communication style and employee commitment	Findings related to our focus show that the 5 dimensions chosen do relate positively to employee commitment to change. 4 limits to the research are highlighted..
3					
4					

- It may help to categorise the content of literature that you find according to purpose, themes, research methods and conclusions perhaps by using a database such as Excel. You will probably have your own views about which categories to use.
- This is separate from the creation of the reference list which can be done in Refworks – see slide 17.

Company and market databases

- Marketline – Company and industry profiles
 - Extra databases include:
 - City statistics – socio-economic stats
 - Country statistics
 - Financial deals tracker
- FAME – Financial Analysis made easy – UK company financial info
- Euromonitor – market analysis package
- Mintel – 5 streams: Leisure, Travel, e-commerce, Food, Clothing and Footwear; Plus Mintel Trends.

References and contact details

- Bell, J. & Waters, S. (2014) *Doing your research project: a guide for first-time researchers*. [Internet]. 6th ed. Maidenhead, Open University Press. Available from <https://capitadiscovery.co.uk/yorks/items/101594> (especially chapter 6).
- Bryman, A. (2016) *Social research methods*. 4th ed. Oxford, Oxford University Press.
- Saunders, M., Lewis, P. & Thornhill, A. (2019) *Research methods for business students*. [Internet]. 8th ed. Harlow, Pearson Education. Available from <https://capitadiscovery.co.uk/yorks/items/483645> (especially chapter 3).
- Wallace, M. & Wray, A. (2016) *Critical reading and writing for postgraduates*. 3rd ed. London, Sage.
- Library & Learning Services homepage: www.yorks.ac.uk/ils/
- Contact Librarian: Jane Munks, Academic Liaison Librarian for the York Business School. Email j.munks@yorks.ac.uk
- Book an online tutorial with Jane via this link: <https://outlook.office365.com/owa/calendar/JaneMunks@yorks.ac.uk/bookings/>